

INDEPENDENT CONTRACTOR CONSULTING AGREEMENT

This Agreement is entered into by and between Aether Dynamics LLC (Client) and Kestrel Security Advisory Inc. (Contractor).

1. CONSULTING SERVICES AND DELIVERABLES. Contractor shall deliver cybersecurity penetration testing and architecture review services in accordance with Schedule A milestones.
2. COMPENSATION AND EXPENSES. Client shall remit a fixed fee of \$18,500.00 within forty-five (45) days of receipt of undisputed milestone completion invoices.
3. INDEPENDENT CONTRACTOR STATUS. Contractor acts as an independent contractor, assuming sole liability for all state, federal, and local income and payroll taxes.
4. CONFIDENTIALITY AND NONDISCLOSURE. Contractor agrees to hold all client architectural designs and vulnerability assessments in confidence for five (5) years following project completion.
5. UNILATERAL CONTRACTOR INDEMNIFICATION. Contractor shall defend and indemnify Client against all claims, liabilities, losses, and damages arising out of Contractor's performance or negligence.
6. TERMINATION FOR CONVENIENCE. Client may terminate this agreement at any time without cause upon fourteen (14) days prior written notice, paying only for completed deliverables.
7. GOVERNING LAW AND SEVERABILITY. This Agreement shall be governed by California law. If any provision is deemed unenforceable, remaining terms remain in full force.